

790 CE The area becomes the eastern frontier province (Ostmark) of the Frankish Empire and later part of Charlemagne's Holy Roman Empire.

976 Emperor Otto II gives the province to a member of the Babenberg family, who rule it for the next 270 years.

1278 Count Rudolf of Habsburg, Holy Roman Emperor from 1273, invades Austria and Styria. In 1282 he declares the title of Duke of Austria to be hereditary, thus founding the Habsburg domination of Austria that is to last until 1918. Over the next two centuries, the Habsburgs steadily increase their lands through strategic marriages, gaining Burgundy, the Netherlands, and eventually Spain and southern Italy, as well as lands belonging to Hungary.

1516–56 Under Charles V the Habsburg Empire reaches its zenith, stretching from the Americas to the Low Countries, with Austria acquiring control over much of Bohemia in 1526 and forming a bulwark of Christian resistance against the Ottoman Turks.

1529 The Ottomans besiege Vienna but fail to capture it.

1556 On the abdication of Charles V, the vast Habsburg empire is split in two, with Austria controlling lands in Germany and the rest going to Habsburg Spain.

1648 The Treaty of Westphalia, signed at the conclusion of the 30 Years War involving Catholic Austria, France, and Spain and Protestant Germany, England, Scandinavia, and Holland, marks the decline of the Holy Roman Empire as a political unit, with German states securing their sovereignty. It heralds the start of the Habsburgs' long decline in relation to France and Prussia.

1683 The Ottomans again besiege Vienna; the country is saved by a multinational army of Germans and Poles led by Jan Sobieski. From now on, Austria takes the offensive against the Ottomans and steadily advances at their expense into the Balkans, gaining Hungary in 1699.

1713 The Treaty of Utrecht, negotiated at the end of the War of the Spanish Succession, confirms Habsburg claims to the former Spanish Netherlands, as well as gaining Milan and, for a time, Naples, Sardinia, and Sicily in Italy. Austria acquires Tuscany in 1737, confirming its hold on Italy.

1748 The Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle brings to an end the War of Austrian Succession, which broke out in 1740 following the death of Charles VI, the last male Habsburg heir. It recognizes his daughter, Maria Theresa, as ruler of the Habsburg lands, although Silesia is ceded to Prussia.

1772–97 Successive partitions of Poland with Russia and Prussia take place. In 1772 Austria gains Galicia in the first partition. In 1795 it gains "lesser Poland,"

including Cracow, in the third partition. The end of Poland as an independent nation is confirmed by treaty in 1797.

1793 Austria declares war against revolutionary France in support of Louis XVI, whose wife, Marie Antoinette, is an Austrian princess.

1805 The Austrians and Russians are defeated at the battle of Austerlitz by Napoleon, who incorporates many Austrian territories into France, or the new Confederation of the Rhine. In 1806 Franz I of Austria (who had declared himself emperor the year before) is obliged to renounce his title as Holy Roman Emperor as the empire is dissolved by Napoleon. In 1809–13 Austria is allied with France after a massive defeat at Wagram, but changes sides to defeat Napoleon at the Battle of the Nations at Leipzig in 1813. The Congress of Vienna of 1814–15, which settles the map of post-Napoleonic Europe, brings territorial gains to Austria, most significantly in northern Italy, and makes Austria titular head of the German Confederation, largely due to the astute diplomacy of Chancellor Metternich.

1848 Popular revolutions within the Habsburg domains lead to Metternich's resignation, the abdication of Emperor Ferdinand, and, with Russian help in Hungary, the succession to the throne of his nephew Franz Josef (1848–1916).



Marie Theresa

Only 23 when she came to the throne in 1740, Marie Theresa became one of the outstanding enlightened rulers of the 18th century, famed for her courage and determination.

DECISIVE MOMENT

THE ASSASSINATION OF DOLLFUSS, 1934

Engelbert Dollfuss (1892–1934) became chancellor of Austria in May 1932. His fear of socialist revolt led him in March 1933 to suspend parliament and, in February 1934, to use the army against the socialists in Vienna. In May he introduced a fascist-style constitution, but he was an isolated figure, hated by the left and by the Nazis who wanted a union with Germany. On July 25, 1934, he was shot dead by Nazi agents who had entered the Chancellery. His body is seen here being carried out. Dollfuss's death weakened Austria, and opened the way to Hitler's takeover in 1938.



1859–60 Austria loses most of its Italian possessions as Italy unifies.

1866 After Prussia unilaterally ends the German Confederation, it declares war on Austria and defeats it in the Seven Weeks War, excluding it from German affairs. Austria loses the Duchy of Holstein to Prussia and Venetia to Italy.

1867 An Austro-Hungarian "dual monarchy," with independent parliaments for each country, is established by Franz Josef; the two countries keep a common army, currency, and customs union.

1908 Austria annexes Bosnia-Herzegovina in the Balkans, heightening international tension.

1914 The start of World War I is precipitated by assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand, heir to the Austrian Habsburg throne, by a Serbian extremist. Austria-Hungary invades Serbia, but is unsuccessful until the following year when its armies are supported by German troops.

1918 At the end of World War I the Austrian Republic is proclaimed following the abdication of Emperor Charles and the collapse of the Austro-Hungarian empire.

1919 The Treaty of St. Germain between Austria and the Allies reduces Austria to a rump state as a result of territorial concessions made to the new states of Czechoslovakia, Hungary, Poland, and Yugoslavia. Anschluss or union with Germany is forbidden.

1933 Parliamentary government is suspended by the Christian Social Chancellor Engelbert Dollfuss.

1934 Dollfuss starts imprisoning social democrats, communists, and National Socialist (Nazi) Party members. The Nazis attempt a coup and assassinate Dollfuss.

1938 Anschluss as Austria is incorporated into Germany by Hitler and renamed Ostmark. Chancellor Kurt Schuschnigg imprisoned.

1945 At the end of World War II, Austria is occupied by Soviet, UK, US, and French forces. Elections result in a coalition of

the Austrian People's Party (ÖVP) and the Social Democrats (SPÖ).

1950 Attempted coup by Communist Party fails. Marshall Aid helps economic recovery.

1955 Austrian State Treaty signed, terminating the occupation and recognizing Austria as a neutral sovereign state.

1971 SPÖ government formed under Bruno Kreisky, who dominates Austrian politics for 12 years.

1986 Kurt Waldheim, former UN secretary general, is elected president, despite war crimes allegations. Jörg Haider becomes leader of the right-wing Freedom Party (FPÖ), prompting the SPÖ to pull out of government. Elections produce a stalemate and a return to the "grand coalition" of the ÖVP and SPÖ in 1987, which lasts until 1999.

1992 Thomas Klestil of the ÖVP elected president. Elections confirm some traditional ÖVP supporters defecting to the FPÖ.

1995 Austria joins the EU.

1998 Klestil reelected president.

1999 Haider's FPÖ wins 40 percent of votes in Carinthia regional poll and ties for second with ÖVP in general election in October; the SPÖ remains as the largest party.

2000 ÖVP accepts FPÖ into coalition, with Wolfgang Schüssel as chancellor, prompting a political crisis as EU imposes diplomatic sanctions.

2002 Austria adopts the euro.

2008 Far-right-wing parties including Jörg Haider's People's Party win 29 percent of the vote in parliamentary elections. Haider is killed in a car crash.

«134–35 Celtic Warriors.
«186–87 The Black Death
«262–63 The 30 Years War
«296–97 The First Global Conflict
«306–07 The Napoleonic Wars